

Welcome to OPMGT 550 C/D: Project Management

Class: Wednesdays 6:00-9:30pm; PCAR 394
Instructor: Jennifer Graves
Email: jdewhitt@uw.edu
Office Hours: Weds 1:30-2:15pm and by appointment via Zoom Meeting ID: 993-6040-6125 (*except no office hours 10/8 and 11/26*)
Fireside chat: (Optional) come ask me anything life or career related Weds Oct 15th and Weds Nov 19th 2:15pm-3:00pm in-person by the Paccar fireplace (next to Orin café).

Lead TA: Lauren Parker (*preferred contact via Canvas regarding grading questions*)
TA office hours: Tues/Thurs 5:45pm-6:45pm Zoom Meeting ID: 935 3438 5149

Course Description and Objectives

"Quietly but powerfully, projects have displaced operations as the economic engine of our times." Harvard Business Review

In recent years, there has been a rapidly increasing emphasis on project management (PM) concepts and expertise, given the importance of successfully completing complex projects. Projects are critical to the success of organizations as they are the primary catalyst for transformative change and drive both short-term performance and long-term value creation.

Further, research indicates that public companies that miss visible milestones (*e.g.*, the announced introduction of a new product) suffer a significant loss in market value that *persists over time*. Thus, the ability to deliver projects on time and in scope has become a strategic priority for many organizations and a critical skill for aspiring leaders.

This course examines the management of complex projects and related concepts, tools, and trade-offs. Throughout the course we will emphasize the importance of managing project risk and why this may be the most important part of managing complex projects. Other topics include project selection and initiation, project life cycles, scheduling and budgeting, agile, decentralized projects and contracts, and managing project teams. In addition, we will discuss commercial PM software products, and the relationship between these products and the requirements of managing risky complex projects in today's economic environment.

Course Prerequisites: MBA core curriculum. While not a prerequisite, it is strongly advised that every student complete the Foster Excel for Business online course.

Required materials

Textbook: Klastorin, T and G. Mitchell. 2021. *Project Management: A Risk Management Approach*. Sage Publications.

Cases: There are three cases. We will provide two of them. Purchase the third at Harvard Publishing [here](#).

Grading

In accordance with Foster policy, [this class will be curved](#) for a median grade between 3.4 and 3.6.

Your final grade will be determined as follows:

Participation	10%
Problem Sets	20%
Case Studies	20%
Final exam	50%

Participation: In-class participation serves to enhance the learning environment for everyone. Active participation helps students better remember information, clarify difficult concepts, and increase understanding by applying class concepts to what is most relevant to their lives. Not to mention, a question you have could be a valuable learning opportunity for someone else who has the same question. Participation comprises of Quizzes and Case Discussions.

- **Quizzes:** There will be 10 quizzes, spread out during the entire course. Quizzes are intended to help you quickly work with the material learned in class. As such, they are short and due by 11:59pm the day after the module ends. See Canvas for the actual deadlines. Note: Panopto recordings often take 48hrs to post after a lecture and may not be available prior to the quiz due date.
- **Case discussions:** There will be two in-class case discussions and one case-activity (Skyscraper Challenge). Each student is expected to have 1 high quality comment across both cases (e.g., synthesis of the case learnings) or 2 medium quality comments across in each case (e.g., initial case facts). An incorrect answer will not reduce points (you won't earn any positive points, but a wrong answer won't "cancel out" a correct answer). Passing on answering or being unprepared will result in negative points. Please be sensitive to the need for other classmates to actively participate. There will be one grade entry on Canvas for case discussions (combined). **A warm call list** will be used to notify students in advance of the date they may be called upon spontaneously for case questions. I will not call on students outside of their warm call day unless a student raises their hand. It is still up to you to gain your participation points so do participate outside of just your warm-call date!
- **Classroom norms:** Class norms are expectations and policies we will co-create on the first day of class to have an ideal learning environment for all students. Violation of these norms will lower your participation grade.

Problem Sets and Case Study Write-ups: There are three case study write-ups (team assignments) and two problem sets (individual assignments). Timely completion of assignments will help you develop a strong conceptual foundation to apply to future classes. For the sake of equity and fairness, all students will have the same amount of time to demonstrate their mastery of assignments.

- **Late policy:** Late assignments (except students with accommodations) will not receive credit as an indication that an acceptable level of mastery was not shown in the time allotted.
- **Format:** You must submit the assignments on Canvas before the due date specified in the format specified on Canvas. Do not email links to google docs or attachments of your homework.
- **Note:** **the last case study is the Skyscraper Challenge which you must attend in-person.** You will compete with your teams in class and will turn in your case write-up by the end of class.

Final exam: The final exam will be conducted **in-person** during the last day of class. Part of the exam will require the use of a personal laptop and part of the exam will be written. Exams are closed notes, closed book, and no use of the internet. If you have a valid scheduling conflict, please inform me at least two weeks prior to the exam. If you do not make arrangements beforehand, no make-up exam will be given.

Tentative Course Calendar

(subject to change; see Canvas and class announcements for latest schedule)

<u>Date</u>	<u>Chapter</u>	<u>Topic</u>	<u>Assignment</u>
Wed, Sep 24	Ch 1 & Ch 3 sup.	Introduction	
Wed, Oct 1	Ch 2 & Ch 12	Project selection	
Wed, Oct 8	Ch 3 & Ch 4	ZOOM class (professor office hour link) Plan a new project	Case 1: due Tues 10/7
Wed, Oct 15	Ch 5	Required pre-work (recorded video) Create a base schedule	
Wed, Oct 22	Ch 6	Estimate costs and time-cost trade-offs	Problem set 1 due Tues 10/21
Wed, Oct 29	Ch 7 & Ch 8	Required pre-work (recorded video) Manage complex schedules	
Wed, Nov 5	Ch 11	Measure progress	Case 2: due Tues 11/4
Wed, Nov 12	Ch 9	Lead teams	Problem set 2 due Tues 11/11
Wed, Nov 19	Ch 10	Engage stakeholders & Achieve project success Required class 11/19	Case 3: Skyscraper writeup due end of class Nov 19
Wed, Nov 26		No class Thanksgiving	
Wed, Dec 3		FINAL EXAM during class Weds 12/3 6:00-7:50pm PCAR 394	

Course Policies

PMP Certification

This course satisfies the PM education requirement for the PMP (Professional Project Manager) certification examination offered by PMI (Project Management Institute). You must also complete an application demonstrating your experience in the project management field. I will be happy to assist with your application and will briefly discuss PMI and the certification exam in class. While many of the concepts discussed in this class are covered on the PMP certification exam, please note that this class is **NOT** a PMP preparation class.

Syllabus Purpose and Disclaimer

Every effort will be made to avoid changing the course schedule, but adjustments may be necessary to accommodate errors, omissions, or unforeseen events (such as weather events). In the event changes are made to the syllabus, students will be informed during class and on the course website. It is your responsibility to be aware of these changes, so please check the course site often.

Academic Integrity and Student Conduct

This program employs the principles and procedures espoused by the University of Washington Community Standards and Student Conduct guidelines to maintain academic integrity in the course. The Code establishes the expectation that students will practice high standards of professional honesty and integrity. In particular, implementation of the Code at the Foster School of Business prohibits cheating, attempted cheating, and plagiarism—including improper citations of source material—as it pertains to academic work. Suspected violations will be handled in compliance with the University of Washington Student Conduct Code as outlined in Washington Administrative Code 478-121.

University of Washington's Academic misconduct policy prohibits students from turning in papers they did not write without proper citation. **This means that using an AI generator such as ChatGPT will be considered a violation of the honor code.**

Students are strictly prohibited from sharing any content from ANY assignment (including but not limited to homework assignments, lab reports, quizzes, and exams) with any website or app (including but not limited to Discord, Chegg, Course Hero, and Snapchat) or any other course content repository (virtual OR physical) that is not explicitly approved by the instructor. **This prohibition applies both during the quarter that you are taking this course and any time after the course ends.**

Access and Accommodations

Your experience in this class is important. If you have already established accommodations with Disability Resources for Students (DRS), please communicate your approved accommodations to me at your earliest convenience so we can discuss your needs in this course.

If you have not yet established services through DRS, but have a temporary health condition or permanent disability that requires accommodations (conditions include but not limited to; mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, physical or health impacts), you can learn more here: <http://depts.washington.edu/uwdrs/>

Religious Accommodations Policy

Washington state law requires that UW develop a policy for accommodation of student absences or significant hardship due to reasons of faith or conscience, or for organized religious activities. The UW's policy, including more information about how to request an accommodation, is available at Religious Accommodations Policy (<https://registrar.washington.edu/staffandfaculty/religious-accommodations-policy/>). Accommodations must be requested within the first two weeks of this course using the Religious Accommodations Request form (<https://registrar.washington.edu/students/religious-accommodations-request/>).

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